

Video is next

Advertisements attached to streaming videos is the fastest growing sector in online marketing, with a staggering 46 per cent growth rate

India over internet

Experts feel online marketing in India is short-lived, and mobile marketing will take over as more people have mobile phones

Local advertising

WebVisible's 2009 Quarter 3 report states that all around the world, SMBs are increasingly moving on to the internet as a cost-effective and high-returns alternative

Feature

value. That's Cost Per Click, or basically, you pay a small amount for each person who clicks on your ad. Another form of advertising that's offered up by sites with large traffic is CPM, or Cost Per Mille (thousand). Since these large sites usually have millions of visitors, you're charged for impressions — or basically how many times your ad is displayed.

Now this is expensive — consider that the average cost of advertising on Yahoo! is \$6,000 for 300,000 impressions in a month. That is a CPM of \$20 per 1000 impressions, or Re. 1 per display.

Other sites, such as Facebook, offer more dedicated, user-focused advertising. Go to www.facebook.com/ads/create, and you will find that the minimum CPM rate is \$0.02, but you also get an estimate of how many people you can expect to reach. Advertising on Facebook is a bidding process, and you enter the details of your target audience, and depending on the popularity of the advertising space, you pay accordingly. This is most definitely something you should check out, because at last count, a little over 8.2 million Indians are registered there.

Search

Search engine marketing, or SEM, is a form of internet marketing that seeks to promote web sites by increasing their visibility in search engine results through the use of contextual advertising and paid inclusion.

Ad programs such as Google Adwords allow marketers to bid on terms. Once



Search Engine Optimisation involves a lot of analysis

content of your web site in order to ensure that it is highly ranked on a search results page when people search for certain keywords. SEO works by improving the framework and infrastructure of your web site, and is no simple task. For one, you need to know how search engines index web sites. People are often mistaken about the nature of SEO, with most believing that repeating a chosen keyword over and over again on your web site will help it rank higher. The credibility to your content depends on the number of visitors, the number of sites linking to you, the number of competitors with similar content, originality and a long list of other factors. SEO is often so complex that companies leave the job to professionals, choosing to pay experts,

instead of learning how to do so. What makes SEO so important is that results are quantifiable, and easily verified — just check your search engine rank.

One thing to remember is that none of the methods listed earlier can work alone. A recent article by SearchEngineLand mentioned a study which reports that of all the

people that react to display ads, 31 per cent of those people directly click on ads, while 27 per cent use search engines to look for a brand, offer, or product. It's obvious you need both search engine marketing / optimisation as well as display advertising.

The social media collage

Social Media Marketing, by itself is a vast field, but the major advantages are that it's free, and not enough companies have realised its potential, just yet. We don't think we need to stress how important it is to grab the advantage of being a first-mover in your domain. Companies such as Dell and Gillette have run exhaustive campaigns, all of which showed very positive results. In India, the Vodafone ZooZoo campaign hit Facebook even before it hit television. Before you get all gung-ho and run out to start marketing yourself, remember, there are a few prerequisites.

Campaigning media

Let's look at all the mediums available to a company or brand interested in establishing a brand image online.

1. Display advertising
 - a. Banner ads
 - b. Video ads
2. Search
 - a. Search engine optimisation
 - b. Search engine marketing
3. Email marketing
4. Social media
 - a. Social networking sites
 - b. Multimedia sharing sites
 - c. Information sharing
 - d. Corporate blogging / blog marketing
 - e. Microblogging
 - f. Social bookmarking

Then, let's look at the few prerequisites any good marketing campaign should have. Considering the internet is an open forum, care must be taken not to seem too irritating. Other factors that need to be considered

- Cost
- Outreach
- Interaction with users
- Interest generated in campaign / market buzz

A web site

We're stating the obvious, and we know that, but we cannot stress enough the importance of having a site that acts as a link-back to your campaign.

A blog

A blog is your mouthpiece to the public. A web site is good for corporate information, a contact us page, sales figures and other publicity, but a blog is personal, and interactive. Your blog should be indicative of the persona you wish your brand or company to project.

Marketing 101

As of today, Orkut is still the leading social networking site in India with the maximum number of Indians registered on it. However, Facebook seems to rank higher as an option for marketers, and it's growing really fast.



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you bid and buy these phrases, your ads will appear on sites that have Google AdSense enabled. This is the bread and butter of companies like Google, and is their biggest source of revenue. The CPM per keyword is variable, and often adjusted by Google itself based on tools. Terms such as "search engine optimization" could cost you over \$20.

Search engine optimisation, on the other hand, is passive marketing. It focuses on improving the quality and